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Infosys®

Verbal Ability Topics (2025)

Complete Topic List

Pattern :

- Reading Comprehension
- Sentence Correction
- Sentence Selection
- Sentence Completion
- Para Jumbles
- One Word Substitution
- Spotting Error
- Analogy
- Fill in the Blanks

- FOCUS :
- PASSAGE / READING COMPHREHENSION.
- ARTICLES , PREPOSITIONS ,
- SYNONYMS
- PARTS OF SPEECH .
- ESSAY WRITING .

MY BROTHER IS A DOCTOR .


S V O C A
S V O
SHE RUNS FAST .

Reading Comprehension

Passage 1

The invention of the printing press in the 15th century revolutionized human communication. For the first time, books could be produced in large numbers, making knowledge accessible to a wider population. This development contributed to the growth of education, science, and democratic ideas in Europe.

Q1. What was the major impact of the printing press?
(a) It restricted knowledge
(b) It made books accessible to more people
(c) It reduced education
(d) It discouraged democracy

Explanation: The passage highlights wider access to knowledge and growth of education.

Q2. Which of the following is NOT mentioned as an outcome of the printing press?
(a) Growth of science
(b) Growth of democracy
(c) Restriction of education
(d) Spread of knowledge

Passage 2

Globalization has led to greater economic integration between countries. It has created opportunities for businesses to expand, but also increased competition. While consumers benefit from cheaper products, local industries often struggle to survive against multinational corporations.

Q3. According to the passage, one disadvantage of globalization is:
(a) Consumers pay higher prices
(b) Local industries face difficulties
(c) No increase in competition
(d) Businesses cannot expand

Q4. The passage suggests globalization benefits:
(a) Only multinational corporations
(b) Only local industries
(c) Consumers through cheaper products
(d) Nobody

Passage 3

Exercise is essential for maintaining good health. It improves cardiovascular fitness, strengthens muscles, and reduces stress. However, excessive exercise without proper rest may lead to injuries and fatigue. Thus, moderation and balance are key.

Q5. Which of the following is a disadvantage of excessive exercise?
(a) Reduces stress
(b) Causes injuries and fatigue
(c) Improves fitness
(d) Strengthens muscles

Q6. What is the main message of the passage?
(a) Exercise should be avoided
(b) Excessive rest is important
(c) Exercise is good, but should be done in moderation
(d) Stress cannot be reduced by exercise

Passage 4

Electric vehicles (EVs) are being promoted as an alternative to fossil fuel-powered cars. They produce no direct emissions and are therefore considered environmentally friendly. However, challenges such as limited charging infrastructure and high costs still prevent their widespread adoption.

Q7. Which of the following is an advantage of EVs?
(a) They are cheaper than petrol cars
(b) They produce no direct e
missions
(c) They require no infrastructure
(d) They are widely adopted

Q8. What challenge prevents EVs from being widely adopted?
(a) They are too fast
(b) They are too small
(c) High cost and limited charging infrastructure
(d) Lack of government promotion

🎯 Tips to Solve RC

1. **Read the passage quickly once** (skim for main idea).

2. **Spot keywords** (names, dates, numbers, connectors).

3. **Don’t assume outside knowledge** – stick to what’s in the passage.

4. For inference Qs → look for implied meaning, not directly stated.

5. Manage time: Don’t spend >5 minutes on RC in Infosys exam

- **Answer Key**

  1 → b
  2 → c
  3 → b
  4 → c
  5 → b
  6 → c
  7 → b
  8 → c

Sentence Correction

Key Rules for Sentence Correction:

- Subject-Verb Agreement (each, neither, either, one of → singular).
- Correct collocations (insist on, interested in, good at).
- Tense consistency.
- Articles & prepositions.

Q1. Each of the students ___ submitted the assignment.
(a) have
(b) has
(c) are
(d) were

Explanation: "Each" is always singular → takes singular verb "has".

Q2. She do not like cold coffee.
(a) She do not like
(b) She doesn’t like
(c) She don’t likes
(d) No correction

Explanation: Subject = "She" (3rd person singular) → "doesn’t like".

Q3. The bouquet of roses ___ on the table.
(a) are
(b) were
(c) is
(d) have

Explanation: Subject is "bouquet" (singular collective noun) → "is".

Q4. Neither of the boys ___ going to the park.
(a) are
(b) were
(c) is
(d) have

Explanation: "Neither" is singular → use "is".

Q5.

He insisted to go to the library.
(a) He insisted to go
(b) He insisted on going
(c) He insist for going
(d) No correction

Explanation: Correct collocation = "insist on + gerund".

Q6.

The teacher as well as the students ___ present.
(a) are
(b) is
(c) were
(d) have

Explanation: Subject = "teacher" (singular); phrase "as well as" does not affect verb.

Q7.

He has been working here since five years.
(a) since five years
(b) for five years
(c) from five years
(d) No correction

Explanation: "Since" = point of time; "for" = period of time. Correct = "for five years".

Q8. One of my friends ___ going abroad for studies.
(a) are
(b) is
(c) have
(d) were

Explanation: "One of" → singular subject → "is".

Sentence Selection

1.
a) She gave me an advice.
b) She gave me a piece of advice.
c) She gave me advices.

2.
a) The boy who won the prize is my cousin.
b) The boy whom won the prize is my cousin.

3
a) She runs fastly to catch the bus.
b) She runs fast to catch the bus.

4.
a) Neither he nor his friends is guilty.
b) Neither he nor his friends are guilty.

5.

a) This is the book that I was talking about.

b) This is the book which I was talking.

6.

a) He is junior than me.

b) He is junior to me.

7.a) I prefer coffee than tea.

b) I prefer coffee to tea.

Sentence Completion

Q1.

If I ___ earlier, I would not have missed the bus.
(a) wake
(b) wakes
(c) had woken
(d) waking

Explanation: Past perfect + conditional = *had woken*.

Q2.

The soldiers fought bravely ___ their country.
(a) with
(b) for
(c) of
(d) on

Explanation: Correct preposition = *fought for*.

Q3. By the time we reach, the movie ___ .
(a) will have started
(b) has started
(c) starts
(d) had started

Explanation: Future perfect → *will have started*.

Q4.

The teacher insisted ___ silence in the class.
(a) to maintain
(b) on maintaining
(c) for maintaining
(d) maintain

Explanation: Correct collocation = *insist on + gerund*.

Q5.

She was so tired that she ___ asleep on the sofa.
(a) fell
(b) fall
(c) falls
(d) falling

Explanation: Simple past → *fell asleep*.

Q6.

We must hurry, or we ___ the train.
(a) missed
(b) miss
(c) will miss
(d) missing

Explanation: Future result → *will miss*.

Q7.

He was accused ___ stealing money.
(a) to
(b) for
(c) of
(d) with

Explanation: Correct usage = *accused of*.

Q8.

She has been waiting here ___ two hours.
(a) since
(b) for
(c) from
(d) at

Explanation: *For = duration of time*, *Since = point in time*.

📘 Para Jumbles (Sentence Rearrangement)

🔑 **How to Solve Para Jumbles (Step-by-Step)**

- **Find the Opening Sentence**
  - Look for general/introductory statements.
  - Avoid sentences starting with pronouns (*he, she, it, this*).
- **Find the Closing Sentence**
  - Look for concluding words (*thus, therefore, finally, hence*).
- **Identify Mandatory Pairs**
  - Sentences that logically follow each other (cause → effect, noun → pronoun).
- **Check for Transition Words**
  - Sequence (*first, then, later*).
  - Contrast (*but, however, although*).
  - Cause-effect (*because, so, therefore*).
- **Read the Full Flow**
  - After arranging, re-read → It must sound natural & coherent.

Para Jumbles

Set 1

A. Ramesh went to the market to buy vegetables.
B. He returned home empty-handed.
C. He searched everywhere but found none fresh.
D. Unfortunately, all vegetables were sold out.

Set 2

A. The team trained hard for months.
B. Finally, their efforts paid off.
C. They worked on both fitness and strategy.
D. They went on to win the championship.

SET 1 :

Answer: A – D – C – B
Explanation:

Intro (A) → Situation (D) → Search (C) → Result (B).

SET 2 :

Answer: A – C – B – D
Explanation:

Training (A) → Details (C) → Result (B) → Achievement (D).

Set 3

A. Birds return to their nests.
B. The sun sets in the west.
C. Evening slowly falls.
D. People finish their day’s work.

Set 4

A. Online shopping has grown rapidly.
B. It saves people time and effort.
C. Many prefer it over traditional shopping.
D. However, some still worry about product quality.

SET 3 :

Answer: B – C – D – A
Explanation:

Natural sequence → sunset → evening → people → birds.

Answer: A – B – C – D
Explanation:

Intro (A) → Benefit (B) → Preference (C) → Concern (D).

Set 5

- A. The scientist explained his theory.
  B. He presented strong evidence.
  C. Many experts accepted his explanation.
  D. His research was later awarded a prize.

One Word Substitution

People & Professions

- **Polyglot** → A person who knows many languages.
- **Misanthrope** → A person who hates mankind.
- **Philanthropist** → A person who loves mankind / does charitable work.
- **Autobiography** → Life story written by oneself.
- **Biography** → Life story written by someone else.
- **Orphan** → A child without parents.
- **Pedestrian** → A person who travels on foot.

Habits & Beliefs

- **Optimist** → One who always looks at the bright side.
- **Pessimist** → One who always looks at the dark side.
- **Atheist** → A person who does not believe in God.
- **Theist** → A person who believes in God.
- **Introvert** → A shy, reserved person.
- **Extrovert** → An outgoing, social person.
- **Omnivorous** → Eating both plants and animals.

Objects & Practices

- **Manuscript** → A handwritten document.
- **Monologue** → A long speech by one person.
- **Dialogue** → Conversation between two persons.
- **Soliloquy** → Speaking aloud to oneself (in drama).
- **Autocracy** → Government by one person with absolute power.
- **Democracy** → Government by the people

Special Terms

- **Epitaph** → Words written on a tombstone.
- **Eulogy** → Speech praising someone, usually after death.
- **Hypochondriac** → A person unduly worried about their health.
- **Ambidextrous** → Able to use both hands equally well.
- **Illiterate** → A person who cannot read or write.
- **Bibliophile** → A lover of books.
- **Arsonist** → One who deliberately sets fire to property.

Tips to Remember One-Word Substitution

- Group them by **people, beliefs, government, objects**.
- Connect with **roots & prefixes** (*bio* = *life*, *auto* = *self*, *philo* = *love*, *mis* = *hate*).
- Practice with **flashcards** for faster recall.

Spotting Error

Spotting Error – Key Rules

- When solving spotting error questions, watch out for:
- **Subject-Verb Agreement** → *Each of the boys has… (not have)*
- **Tenses** → Correct use of past, present, perfect.
- **Prepositions** → *Good at, not good in*
- **Articles** → *He is an honest man (not a honest man)*
- **Pronouns** → Agreement with antecedent.
- **Comparisons** → *She is taller than me (not than I)*
- **Miscellaneous** → Double negatives, incorrect modifiers, misplaced words.

1. Each of the boys *have* submitted their homework.
(a) Each of the boys
(b) have
(c) submitted their homework
(d) No error

2. She is *good in* dancing.
(a) She is
(b) good in
(c) dancing
(d) No error

3. The police *has* arrested the thief.
(a) The police has
(b) arrested
(c) the thief
(d) No error



4. He insisted *to go* there.
(a) He insisted
(b) to go
(c) there
(d) No error



5. Neither of the two friends *were* present.
(a) Neither of
(b) the two friends
(c) were
(d) present

6. He is senior *than* me by two years.
(a) He is
(b) senior than
(c) me by
(d) two years

Q7.

One of my friend *is* going abroad.

(a) One of

(b) my friend

(c) is going

(d) abroad

1. She is very good **in** singing.

2. One of my friend is coming today.

3. Neither of the girls have done her homework.

4. He is senior **than** me.

5. He is married **with** my cousin.

Analogy

Definition:
An analogy tests the relationship between **two words** and asks you to find another pair with the **same relationship**.

Common Types in Infosys:

- **Tool - User** (Pen : Writer)
- **Object - Function** (Knife : Cut)
- **Cause - Effect** (Fire : Smoke)
- **Synonyms/Antonyms**
- **Part - Whole** (Wheel : Car)

Tips for Analogy Questions

- First **identify the exact relationship** in the first pair.
- Eliminate options that **don’t match the same logic**.
- Watch out for **synonym/antonym traps**.
- Re-check if the pair makes complete sense in both directions.

1. Pen : Writer :: Brush : ?
(a) Sculptor
(b) Artist
(c) Author
(d) Singer

2. Doctor : Hospital :: Teacher : ?
(a) Book
(b) School
(c) Classmate
(d) College

3. Knife : Cut :: Needle : ?
(a) Sew
(b) Prick
(c) Thread
(d) Cloth

4. Fire : Smoke :: Rain : ?
(a) Water
(b) Flood
(c) Clouds
(d) Umbrella

5. Optimist : Pessimist :: Brave : ?
(a) Strong
(b) Coward
(c) Hero
(d) Fear

6. Bird : Nest :: Bee : ?
(a) Hive
(b) Honey
(c) Sting
(d) Buzz

Fill in the Blanks

Definition:
Fill in the blanks test your knowledge of **grammar, vocabulary, prepositions, tenses, and contextual usage**.

Types of Questions:

- **Grammar-based** (prepositions, tenses, articles)
- **Vocabulary-based** (meaning, collocations)
- **Contextual** (sentence meaning/logic

Q1. Grammar-based

She is married ___ a doctor.
(a) with
(b) to
(c) by
(d) for

Q2. He has been working here ___ 2018.
(a) since
(b) for
(c) from
(d) at

Q3. Vocabulary-based

The teacher was known for her ___ nature.
(a) cruel
(b) generous
(c) hostile
(d) arrogant

Explanation: Context expects a positive quality → *generous*.

Q4. Contextual

The new policy will come ___ effect next month.
(a) on
(b) into
(c) in
(d) with

Explanation: Correct phrase = *come into effect*.

Q5. Grammar-based

- By the time we reach the station, the train ___ .
  (a) leaves
  (b) has left
  (c) will have left
  (d) leaving
- **Explanation:** Future perfect tense = *will have left*

Q6. Vocabulary-based

- The thief was caught and ___ to the police.
  (a) handed
  (b) delivered
  (c) sent
  (d) posted
- **Explanation:** Correct usage = *handed to the police*.

Q7. Contextual

- The child was so tired that he ___ asleep immediately.
  (a) fall
  (b) fell
  (c) falls
  (d) falling
- **Explanation:** Past tense is correct here → *fell asleep*.

ARTICLES :

What are Articles?

- Articles are words that define a noun as **specific or unspecific**.
- **Types:**
  - **Definite Article** → *the* (used for something specific/unique).
  - **Indefinite Articles** → *a, an* (used for general/non-specific things).

Important Tips (Infosys-Oriented)

- **Indefinite Articles: a / an**
  - *a* → before consonant sounds (*a book*, *a university*).
  - *an* → before vowel sounds (*an apple*, *an hour*).
  - ⚠️ Sound matters, not spelling:
    - *an honest man* ✅ (because "h" is silent).
    - *a European country* ✅ (because "Eu" sounds like "you").
- **Definite Article: the**
  - Use for **unique things** (*the sun*, *the moon*).
  - Use when both speaker and listener know the object (*I saw the movie we discussed*).
  - Before **superlatives** (*the best student*).
- **No Article**
  - Before plural/general nouns (*Books are useful*).
  - Before abstract nouns in general sense (*Honesty is important*).

Common Errors (Infosys traps)

- ❌ She is **a honest** girl.
  ✅ She is **an honest** girl.

- ❌ The Mount Everest is the highest mountain.
  ✅ Mount Everest is the highest mountain. (*No "the" before proper nouns, unless it's "the Ganga, the Himalayas"*).

- ❌ He is good in playing a guitar.
  ✅ He is good at playing **the** guitar. (*use "the" before musical instruments*).

EXCERSICES :

Fill in the blanks with correct article (a/an/the or no article):

- He is ___ engineer who works in Infosys.
- We saw ___ one-eyed man yesterday.
- She is ___ university student.
- My father likes playing ___ violin.
- ___ honesty is the best policy.

👉 **Error Spotting:**

- She wants to become a MBA in future.
- We went to see the Mount Abu last summer.
- He is a honest policeman.
- My brother is reading the Times of India.
- She has bought an European car.

PREPOSITION

What are Prepositions?

- Prepositions are words placed **before a noun/pronoun** to show relation with other words in the sentence.
- They indicate **time, place, direction, cause, manner, instrument, agent, etc.**
- **Examples:** in, on, at, by, with, about, since, for, between, among, from, into, onto.

Prepositions of Time

- *at* → exact time (*at 5 PM*).
- *on* → days/dates (*on Monday, on 15th August*).
- *in* → longer periods (*in 2025, in July, in the morning*).

Prepositions of Place/Direction

- *at* → point (*at the station*).
- *in* → inside (*in the room*).
- *on* → surface (*on the table*).

Commonly Confused

- Different **from** (not *than*).
- Complain **about** (not *for*).
- Good **at** (not *in*).
- Married **to** (not *with*).

Sentence Selection (Choose correct option)

- Which sentence is correct?
- a) She is waiting **for** the bus.
  b) She is waiting **to** the bus.
  c) She is waiting **on** the bus.

- a) We entered **into** the room quickly.
  b) We entered the room quickly.

B. Error Spotting

Find the error:

- He is senior *than* me.
- The boy was accused *for* stealing.
- She is good *in* painting.
- I prefer tea *than* coffee.

Preposition “TO”

- 👉 **Used to show direction, movement, relation, or comparison.**
- **Direction / Destination:**
  - She goes **to** school every day.
  - I am traveling **to** Delhi.
- **Relationship (verbs + to):**
  - She is married **to** a doctor.
  - This car belongs **to** my uncle.
- **Comparison (senior/junior/superior/inferior to):**
  - He is junior **to** me.
- **Infinitive form (verb use):**
  - I like **to read** books.
- ⚠️ **Common Error Trap (Infosys):**
  ❌ He is senior *than* me.
  ✅ He is senior **to** me.

Preposition “FOR”

- 👉 **Used to show purpose, reason, benefit, or duration.**
- **Purpose / Reason:**
  - This gift is **for** you.
  - He was punished **for** being late.
- **Benefit:**
  - Good health is important **for** everyone.
- **Duration of time (period):**
  - I have been waiting here **for** two hours.
- **Expressions (apologies, excuses, wishes):**
  - Sorry **for** the delay.
  - Best wishes **for** your success.
- ⚠️ **Common Error Trap:**
  ❌ The boy was accused *for* stealing.
  ✅ The boy was accused **of** stealing.

Preposition “OF”

- 👉 **Used to show possession, relationship, material, cause, or composition.**
- **Possession / Relationship:**
  - The book **of** my friend.
  - A friend **of** mine.
- **Whole-Part Relationship:**
  - A piece **of** cake.
  - A bunch **of** keys.
- **Cause / Origin:**
  - He died **of** cancer.
  - She is proud **of** her achievements.
- **Material / Composition:**
  - The ring is made **of** gold.
  - A statue **of** stone.

Fill in the Blanks

- He is interested ___ learning new technologies.
- She has been absent ___ Monday.
- The child was accused ___ lying.
- He is senior ___ me in the office.
- The cat is hiding ___ the table.

PARTS OF SPEECH :

Noun (Name)

- 👉 Shortcut: **If you can put “the/a/an” before it → it’s usually a noun.**
- *the book, an apple, a city*
  💡 Names of people, places, things, ideas.

Pronoun (Replaces Noun)

- 👉 Shortcut: **If it replaces a noun → it’s a pronoun.**
- *he, she, it, they, we, you*
  💡 Quick test: Replace with a name → still makes sense.
- *He is my friend → Ravi is my friend.*

Verb (Action/State)

- 👉 Shortcut: **If it shows action or "is/are/was/were" → verb.**
- *run, eat, is, are, become, write*
  💡 Replace with *do/does/did* → If fits, it's a verb.
- *He runs fast → He does fast* (works structurally).

Adjective (Describes Noun)

- 👉 Shortcut: **If it answers "What kind? How many? Which one?" → adjective.**
- *beautiful girl, three apples, this book*
  💡 Usually before a noun.
- *a tall building*

Adverb (Describes Verb, Adjective, Adverb)

- 👉 Shortcut: **If it answers "How? When? Where? To what extent?" → adverb.**
- *She runs quickly.* (*How?*)
- *He came yesterday.* (*When?*)
  💡 Often ends with **-ly** (*slowly, happily, neatly*).

- **Preposition (Position Word)**
- 👉 Shortcut: **If it shows position/time/relation → preposition.**
- *in, on, at, by, with, from, about, for, of, since, between*
  💡 Rule: Always followed by a noun/pronoun.
- *on the table, at 5 pm, with me*

Conjunction (Joining Word)

- 👉 Shortcut: **If it joins two words/clauses → conjunction.**
- *and, but, or, so, because, although, if, while*
  💡 Trick: Remove it → sentence breaks.

8. Interjection (Emotion Word)

- 👉 Shortcut: **If it shows sudden feeling → interjection.**
- *Wow! Alas! Oh! Hurrah!*
  💡 Usually comes with **exclamation mark (!).**